

Motorola Moto G64 5G

A minor upgrade, but a polished one

Motorola has carved a solid space for itself in India's cutthroat budget smartphone market by focusing on providing an elevated experience at an inexpensive price. One of the company's latest entrants in the budget smartphone realm is the Motorola Moto G64 – the successor to the popular Moto G54 from last year. The Moto G64 improves on a handful of specifications here and there, but this is not one you would deem as a generational upgrade. It faces tough competition from the likes of the Realme P1 and POCO X6 Neo as well. So, can the Motorola Moto G64 make its way into the Indian consumer's consciousness, or will it get lost in the crowd? Let's find out in my detailed Motorola Moto G64 review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Motorola G64 sports a similar design to its predecessor. The PMMA construction feels robust while having a touch of elegance because of its glass-like appearance. At 8.9 mm, it is not the slimmest phone at this price, but Motorola has still managed to keep the weight in check at just 192 g. That's not an easy feat for a phone with a colossal 6,000 mAh battery, so props to Motorola here.

The colours on the new Motorola G64 are refreshing; the Mint Green, Pearl Blue, and Ice Lilac colour variants look fresh and premium. The metallic texture of the camera module also adds to the appeal. Additionally, the rear panel does a great job of resisting fingerprints, keeping its appearance pristine. The buttons, however, feel quite mushy; it's similar to the issue I had with the Moto G54.

The phone also packs dual stereo speakers with Dolby Atmos support

₹14,999



and IP52 dust and water resistance. I think it's high time Motorola starts offering at least an IP54 or IP55 rating since some of its competition has caught up and surpassed it in this regard. So, the Motorola Moto G64 doesn't have any major build and design changes, but the addition of some design flourishes has breathed new life into the budget G series.

DISPLAY

My gripe with the budget Motorola G series' displays continues. The Motorola Moto G64 has the exact same display as its predecessor which was subpar in 2023, so naturally, it is even worse in 2024. This is a 6.5-inch IPS LCD screen with Full HD+ resolution and 120 Hz refresh rate. Content viewed on the display looks crisp and the phone feels fluid because of the high refresh rate, but the colours aren't very accurate.

Moreover, the brightness levels are very low by 2024 standards. With auto-brightness turned on, I only got

a reading of 464 nits under bright sunlight which negatively impacts readability. The viewing angles are also subpar. The display comes with Widevine L1 and HDR support, but you can only watch HDR content on YouTube; Netflix and Amazon Prime Video don't support HDR on this phone yet.

PERFORMANCE

The Moto G64 houses an upgraded MediaTek Dimensity 7025 SoC with an improved maximum clock speed of 2.5 GHz. This is complemented by 8/12 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and 128/256 GB of UFS 2.2 storage. This is one of the most powerful processors at this price point, so there were minimal performance hiccups in my testing. Day-to-day operations were smooth and multitasking was seamless.

In synthetic benchmarks, the Moto G64 brawled against the Realme P1 with each throwing punches and beating the other in different benchmarks. The Moto G64 scored 5,00,558 in AnTuTu v10, which was lower than the Realme P1's stellar 600K+ score but it did comfortably beat out the POCO X6 Neo. In GeekBench, the Moto G64 proved to be superior to the Realme P1 and POCO X6 Neo, in both Single Core and Multi Core tests. The same results prevailed in PCMark Work as well showing the Moto G64's processing power.

However, in GPU benchmarks, the Realme P1 had a stronger showing in every single test. Nevertheless, the Motorola G64 still managed to put out some impressive scores that had the POCO X6 Neo beat. In real-world scenarios, I found that the Realme P1 is a much more reliable gaming phone. The Moto G64 faced random lag and stutters when playing BGMI or Call of Duty: Mobile for more than 15 minutes at Medium graphics which was not the case on the Realme P1.

Gaming performance aside, this is a solid performer though. Moto's MyUX software is one of the cleanest on the block. However, software updates are a problem. Until a few weeks ago, the